

VOURELLE

Elegance, Inherited.

Sourcing Bot Specification

Google Shopping edition · ROAS 2.0 floor · 10% net margin · US, UK and Canada

Build instructions for Claude Code: find, verify and list AliExpress pieces automatically, collate them in Excel by category and subcategory, and hand them to DSers and Shopify.

Version 2026-09-30 · Companion files: vourelle_bot_config.yaml, vourelle_taxonomy.csv

0. Read me first: the brief for Claude Code

Mission. Build a service that runs around the clock and does four jobs: it discovers AliExpress products that match the Vourelle taxonomy (section 5), verifies each one against the hard gates and red flags (sections 2 to 4), writes the results to an Excel workbook sorted by category and subcategory (section 7), and prepares approved pieces for DSers and Shopify (section 8). After launch it keeps checking every live product (section 10).

Order of authority. This PDF is the master specification. The YAML file holds every threshold and the CSV holds the taxonomy. If they disagree, the PDF wins and the conflict must be logged. Every number in this document is a config value, never a hard-coded constant.

Pipeline at a glance

Stage	What happens	Output
S1 Discover	Keyword search per taxonomy row via the AliExpress Affiliate API	Candidate product IDs
S2 Pre-filter	Drop anything that fails cheap checks: price, orders, rating	Short list
S3 Enrich	Full product detail, SKUs, stock, store ratings; freight quote to US, UK and Canada	Enriched records
S4 Gate	Hard gates G-01 to G-20 and red flags F-01 to F-12	Pass, flag or reject with reason codes
S5 Vision	Premium-look score, white-label check, image consistency	Scores and flags
S6 Cluster	Group identical products from different stores; pick primary plus 2 backups	One row per product
S7 Price	Landed cost, minimum price, market prices, margin	Prices and custom labels
S8 Copy	SEO title, description, alt text, tags under brand rules	Listing copy
S9 Output	Excel workbook plus import queue (JSON)	Daily and master files
S10 Import	DSers import, push as draft, Shopify enrichment, publish	Live products
S11 Monitor	Re-check live products every 12 hours; pause, reprice or switch supplier	Actions and alerts

Non-negotiables

- **N-01 Official data access only.** Use the AliExpress Open Platform APIs (Affiliate and Dropshipping) with the founder's own app credentials. Do not solve CAPTCHAs, rotate proxies, spoof browser fingerprints or scrape logged-in pages. AliExpress restricts automated access to its site, and the same AliExpress account runs DSers fulfilment, so a ban would stop every order.
- **N-02 Unknown means not passed.** A field the bot cannot read is marked UNVERIFIED and the product goes to the human review queue. It is never assumed to pass.
- **N-03 No spending.** The bot never places orders, changes Google Ads budgets or bids, or buys samples.
- **N-04 Brand rules are code.** All generated copy passes the linter in section 3.2 before it is saved.
- **N-05 Secrets stay secret.** API keys and tokens live in environment variables or a secrets manager, never in Excel, logs or git.
- **N-06 Idempotent and resumable.** Re-running a stage must not create duplicates. Every decision is logged with its reason codes and the data it was based on.
- **N-07 Config drives everything.** Thresholds, prices, FX rates and weights are read from vourelle_bot_config.yaml at the start of each run and snapshotted into the workbook.

The only human steps

ID	Step	Time
H-1	Approve or reject items in the Review sheet using the human_check column	About 2 minutes per product

ID	Step	Time
H-2	Order a sample of each Hero piece before ad spend; confirm fabric, fit, labels and packaging	Once per Hero
H-3	Set up the store and Merchant Center (section 9.1), handle identity checks and any appeals	One-off, then as needed
H-4	Refunds, disputes and chargebacks	Ongoing
H-5	Weekly: compare actual ROAS, refund rate and fees with config; approve any config change	15 minutes a week

1. Economics and pricing

Google Shopping is the paid channel. The floor is a blended ROAS of 2.0 measured on revenue excluding tax and shipping. Markup is not fixed: the bot derives the minimum price from each product's real landed cost so that every listing clears a 10% net margin at ROAS 2.0.

The formula

$$k = 1 - \text{refund_rate} - 1/\text{target_roas} - \text{payment_fee_rate} - \text{overhead_rate} - \text{target_net_margin} \times (1 - \text{refund_rate})$$

With the config defaults: $k = 1 - 0.12 - 0.50 - 0.035 - 0.06 - 0.10 \times 0.88 = \mathbf{0.197}$. This is the share of each sale left for landed product cost.

Minimum price $P_{\min}$ = $(L + \text{payment_fee_fixed_usd}) \div k$, where L is the landed cost defined below.

Per \$100 of gross sales (ex tax)	Value	Config key
Refunds	12.00	refund_rate
Google Ads (ROAS 2.0)	50.00	target_roas
Payment processing	3.50 + \$0.30 per order	payment_fee_rate, payment_fee_fixed_usd
Overhead (Shopify, apps, DSers, VAT filing, lost parcels)	6.00	overhead_rate
Net profit (10% of \$88 net sales)	8.80	target_net_margin
Left for landed cost	19.70	derived (k)

Landed cost L

- For each country c in US, GB, CA: $L_c = \text{item_price} + \text{ship_cost}_c + \text{duty}_c$, using the heaviest SKU you will list and the cheapest tracked method that passes the delivery gate.
- US duty:** use the import charge returned by AliExpress when available; otherwise $\text{item_price} \times \text{duty_rate}$ (0.45 garments, 0.50 footwear, 0.40 bags, belts and hats, 0.35 jewelry). Most Chinese apparel pays roughly 36% to 52% in total US duty as of September 2026.
- UK duty:** 0 today on parcels of 135 pounds or less. VAT is inside the UK price, not a cost. The relief ends in October 2028 at the latest, so review this date in config.
- Canada duty:** placeholder rates in config marked duty_verified: false. Confirm on a real checkout before launch.
- $L = \max(L_{\text{US}}, L_{\text{GB}}, L_{\text{CA}})$. One price rule covers all three markets.

Setting the price

- $\text{price_usd} = \max(\text{round_up_to_ending_8}(P_{\min}), \text{band_min})$. If $\text{round_up_to_ending_8}(P_{\min})$ is greater than band_max , reject with PRICE_OVER_BAND: the product cannot sell at a competitive price.
- $\text{price_gbp} = \text{price_usd} \times \text{fx_gbp} \times 1.20$ (VAT included), rounded up to a price ending in 0, 5 or 8. $\text{price_cad} = \text{price_usd} \times \text{fx_cad}$, rounded up the same way (GST/HST added at checkout).
- Never set a compare-at or “was” price unless a real, dated sale exists. Fake discounts break the brand rules and Google's misrepresentation policy.

Worked example: pleated wide-leg trousers (band \$68 to \$98)

Step	US	UK	Canada
Item price	\$9.50	\$9.50	\$9.50
Shipping (cheapest passing method)	\$2.80	\$3.10	\$3.40
Duty	\$4.28 (45%)	\$0.00	\$1.71 (18%, unverified)
Landed cost	\$16.58	\$12.60	\$14.61

$L = \$16.58$. $P_{\min} = (16.58 + 0.30) \div 0.197 = \85.66 , rounded up to **\$88**, which sits inside the band. UK price 78.14 pounds rounds to **80 pounds**; Canadian price C\$123.20 rounds to **C\$125**. Markup 5.31x, net margin 10.6% at ROAS 2.0, break-even ROAS 1.69. Illustrative inputs; the bot uses live data.

Why the markup lands around 5x, and how it loosens

At ROAS 2.0, half of every sale goes to Google, so the landed share cannot exceed about 19.7%, which is a markup of at least 5.08x. The markup falls automatically when real numbers improve. Each figure below is the maximum landed share for a 10% net margin.

Blended ROAS	1.8	2.0	2.2	2.5	3.0
Landed share of price	14.1%	19.7%	24.2%	29.7%	36.4%
Minimum markup	7.1x	5.08x	4.1x	3.4x	2.7x

Google Shopping is a realistic place for 2.0: one 2026 benchmark puts the median Google Ads ROAS for fashion at 3.52, against 2.18 on Meta. A new account usually starts lower until it has conversion history.

Measuring ROAS correctly

- Send Google a conversion value that excludes tax and shipping. UK revenue must be the VAT-exclusive amount, or the reported ROAS will be about 20% too high.
- ROAS in this model is on gross sales before refunds, because refunds are a separate line. Do not double-count them in Google.
- Update refund_rate, payment_fee_rate and overhead_rate from actual results each month (H-5). The ceiling recalculates for every product on the next run.

2. Hard gates: every product must pass all of them

*Gates run in the order shown so that cheap checks fail fast. Tier thresholds come from supplier_gates in config: Hero rows use hero, Core rows use standard and Add-on rows use addon. Country codes: the United Kingdom is **GB** in every API call.*

ID	Check	Rule (config key)	If it fails
G-01	Ships to all three	A tracked method exists to US, GB and CA (shipping.required_countries)	REJECT SHIP_MISSING_xx
G-02	Delivery time	Processing plus transit, upper bound of the estimate, is 9 days or less in every country (max_delivery_days)	REJECT SHIP_SLOW_xx
G-03	Shipping cost	Cheapest tracked method that passes G-02 costs \$4.99 or less per unit in every country (max_ship_cost_usd)	REJECT SHIP_COST_xx
G-04	Shipping versus item	Shipping cost in any country is not higher than the item price	REJECT SHIP_GT_ITEM
G-05	Tracking	Method is tracked end to end (require_tracking)	REJECT SHIP_UNTRACKED
G-06	Orders	Lifetime orders at or above tier minimum (min_orders)	REJECT LOW_ORDERS
G-07	Reviews and rating	Review count and average rating at or above tier minimum	REJECT LOW_REVIEWS or LOW_RATING
G-08	Photo reviews	Customer photo reviews at or above tier minimum (min_photo_reviews)	REJECT, or REVIEW if UNVERIFIED
G-09	Store health	Store ratings (item as described, communication, shipping speed) 4.6 or higher; positive feedback 95% or higher; store open 1 year or more	REJECT STORE_xx, or REVIEW if UNVERIFIED
G-10	Variants	Apparel: 3+ colours, 2+ of them on-palette, sizes S to XL all present, 12+ listable SKUs. One-size: 2+ colours, 1+ on-palette	REJECT FEW_VARIANTS, OFF_PALETTE or SIZE_GAP
G-11	Variant price spread	No listed SKU priced more than 15% above the cheapest listed SKU (drop outliers first)	REJECT PRICE_SPREAD
G-12	Inventory	Apparel: total stock 1,000+ and 100+ per core size (S, M, L) in each listed colour. One-size: 500+	REJECT LOW_STOCK
G-13	Price fits band	round_up_to_ending_8(P_min) is at or below band_max for the taxonomy row	REJECT PRICE_OVER_BAND
G-14	White-label	Section 3.1 returns PASS or UNVERIFIED (never FAIL)	REJECT BRANDED
G-15	Design and trademark	No blocklist term in title, attributes or description; no known design in images (section 3.4)	REJECT DESIGN_COPY
G-16	Images	5+ images including at least one on-model shot; no watermarks or foreign logos	REJECT FEW_IMAGES or WATERMARK
G-17	Premium look	Vision score 4 or higher on the rubric in section 3.5	REJECT OFF_BRAND_STYLE
G-18	Composition	Fibre or material composition stated; no prohibited material (real fur)	REVIEW FIBRE_UNVERIFIED; REJECT PROHIBITED
G-19	Listing live	Product status active and purchasable	REJECT OFFLINE
G-20	Category enabled	Taxonomy row enabled (Boots and Shoes are on Hold)	SKIP HOLD_CATEGORY

What “less than 10 days” means

Delivery is measured from the customer's order to the door: supplier processing time plus the latest date in the carrier's estimate, in calendar days. The cap is 9 days so that the upper bound is always under 10. Estimates are not guarantees: independent 2026 tracking of AliExpress Choice orders found medians of 5 to 7 days but 90th-percentile times of 9 to 12 days. The website and Merchant Center must therefore publish a slightly wider, honest window (section 9).

Canada is likely to be the bottleneck. The Summary sheet must report pass rates per country so the founder can see how many products fail on Canada alone.

Red flags: scams, fake stock and undeliverable listings

Red flags do not always mean fraud, but each one routes the product to REVIEW or REJECT. A product with any unresolved flag is never auto-approved.

ID	Signal	How to detect	Action
F-01	Placeholder stock	Any SKU stock equals a value in placeholder_stock_values, or every SKU shows the same round number	REVIEW
F-02	Review and order mismatch	Rating 4.9+ with reviews under 2% of orders, or more reviews than orders	REVIEW
F-03	Too cheap to be the same item	Item price under 50% of the cluster median for the same product	REVIEW (often thinner fabric or a bait listing)
F-04	Inflated original price	Listed original price more than 3x the sale price	REVIEW
F-05	Price volatility	Supplier price moved more than 10% in 14 days (snapshot history)	REVIEW
F-06	Images do not match	Vision check finds different garments, colours or fabrics across images or versus SKU names	REJECT IMAGE_MISMATCH
F-07	Listing changed	Title, category or main image changed since the last snapshot	REVIEW
F-08	Slow processing	Supplier processing time more than 3 days (counts toward G-02 anyway)	REVIEW
F-09	Size chart missing	No measurements in cm (bust, waist, length) in attributes or description	REVIEW
F-10	Brand or label hints	Description mentions logo, label, custom brand, or brand attribute is a named brand	REVIEW or REJECT via G-14
F-11	Freight differs by country	Method or price for one country far outside the other two (possible routing problem)	REVIEW
F-12	Store sells unrelated goods	Store category spread wide (for example phone cases plus coats); if available from API	REVIEW

How deliverability is protected

No automated check can prove a seller will ship. The bot stacks five protections so a bad supplier is caught early and replaced quickly.

- **Live freight quote** to a real postcode in each country (sample_postcode) at gate time, not a cached estimate.
- **Re-check within 24 hours before push:** stock, price, freight and status are fetched again. Any change re-runs the gates.
- **Twice-daily monitoring** of every live product (section 10).
- **Two backup suppliers** per product, mapped in DSers, so an out-of-stock primary is swapped instead of paused.
- **Hero samples (H-2)** confirm quality, labels and packaging before ad spend. AliExpress buyer protection covers refunds for undelivered orders.

3. White-label, claims, palette and premium look

3.1 White-label test (G-14)

- **Brand attribute:** PASS if the product's Brand Name property is empty or generic (for example none, NoEnName_Null, OEM, Other). A named brand sends the product to vision checking and REVIEW.
- **Vision:** check every image for visible brand labels, neck-tag text, logos on the garment or hardware, watermarks, store names and promotional text. Any hit is FAIL.
- **Text:** description keywords such as logo, brand label, custom label or printed brand raise F-10.
- **Result:** PASS, UNVERIFIED (nothing found, but labels cannot be seen in photos) or FAIL. Heroes stay UNVERIFIED until the sample confirms (H-2). Plain care and size labels are normal and fine.
- **Packaging:** DSers order note on every order: “Dropshipping order. Please do not include invoices, price tags, promotional cards or supplier branding.”

3.2 Claims rules and copy linter

ID	Rule
C-01	Use “wool” only if composition shows 30% wool or more. Always list the full composition in the description.
C-02	Use “cashmere”, “silk”, “leather” or “suede” only if the composition confirms it. Otherwise say satin, faux leather or faux suede.
C-03	Jewelry: say gold-tone or gold-plated and faux pearl or glass pearl unless solid gold, sterling silver or real pearl is confirmed.
C-04	Real animal fur is prohibited. Faux fur must be named faux fur.
C-05	No exclamation marks, no emoji, no “luxury”, “designer”, “limited”, “hurry” or other urgency words, no brand names except Vourelle.
C-06	American English on the site (color, favorite). Call items pieces. Product copy opens with a feeling, then gives facts.
C-07	Never invent reviews, stock counts, discounts or heritage. The brand is Est. MMXXVI.

3.3 Palette

On-palette colours: camel, oatmeal, cream, ivory, white, stone, beige, tan, cognac, chestnut, brown, chocolate, navy, charcoal, grey, black, burgundy, wine, bottle green, hunter green, emerald, olive, champagne, pale blue, blue-and-white stripe, gold, pearl. Off-palette SKUs (neon, bright pink, lilac, orange and so on) are dropped from the listing, not published. The product still passes if G-10 is met by the remaining colours. Map supplier colour names with a synonym table (for example khaki to camel, apricot to camel, wine red to burgundy) and log every unmapped name.

3.4 Design and trademark blocklist (G-15)

Match whole words, case-insensitive, in title, attributes and description: Burberry, Nova check, Hermes, Kelly, Birkin, Constance, Chanel, Coco, Gucci, horsebit, Louis Vuitton, monogram, Dior, Prada, Miu Miu, Celine, Loewe, Bottega, intrecciato, Loro Piana, Max Mara, Ralph Lauren, Barbour, Moncler, Canada Goose, UGG, Toteme, The Row, Reformation, Sezane, Zara, Mango, Aritzia, Skims, and real-fur terms. Whitelist phrases that contain a blocked word but are safe: hunter green, knit polo, polo collar, polo neck. The vision check also rejects recognisable copies: Burberry-style check, Kelly or Birkin bag shapes, horsebit hardware, interlocking-C buttons.

3.5 Premium-look rubric for the vision model (G-17)

Send up to 6 images per product to a vision-capable Claude model with this rubric and ask for strict JSON: {"score": 1-5, "fails": [...], "logo_or_text": bool, "images_consistent": bool, "on_model": bool, "notes": "..."}.

Score	Meaning
5	Looks like a \$200+ brand piece: substantial fabric with visible texture, clean seams, structured drape, classic cut, neutral colour, calm styling
4	Premium enough for Vourelle once photos are enhanced; minor issues only
3	Mid-market; acceptable only as an add-on
1-2	Fast-fashion look: shiny thin synthetic, cheap hardware, loud print, trendy cut

Automatic fails regardless of score: slogans or graphics, glitter or sequins, neon, cut-outs or overtly sexy styling, visible pilling or loose threads, collage images with Chinese text, heavily distorted models.

4. Scoring and status

Only products that pass every hard gate are scored. The score ranks candidates within a subcategory and decides whether a product can skip the human queue.

Component	Weight	Calculation (clamp each to 0 to 1, then multiply by weight)
Margin headroom	20	$(\text{band_max} - P_{\text{min}}) \div \text{band_max} \div 0.30$; full marks at 30% headroom
Social proof	20	$0.5 \times (\text{rating} - 4.5) \div 0.4 + 0.5 \times \log_{10}(\text{reviews}) \div \log_{10}(2,000)$
Sales velocity	15	$\log_{10}(\text{orders}) \div \log_{10}(10,000)$
Premium look	20	$(\text{vision score} - 3) \div 2$
Delivery speed	10	$(9 - \text{average of the three countries' max days}) \div 5$
Variants and palette	10	$0.5 \times \min(1, \text{palette colours} \div 5) + 0.5 \times \text{share of XS to XXL covered}$
Shipping cost	5	$(5 - \text{highest shipping cost across countries}) \div 5$

Status rules

Status	Condition
APPROVED	All gates pass, no flags, no UNVERIFIED fields, score 70+, and the daily cap is not reached
APPROVED_QUEUED	Would be APPROVED but the daily or per-category cap is reached; carried to the next day in score order
REVIEW	All gates pass but at least one flag or UNVERIFIED field, or score 55 to 69. The human_check column says exactly what to verify
REJECTED	Any gate fails, or score under 55. Reason codes recorded; kept 30 days for pass-rate analysis
LIVE	Published on Shopify and in the Merchant Center feed
PAUSED	Live product failing a monitor check (section 10); unpublished or set out of stock

Throughput and balance

- At most 10 new APPROVED products per day, and at most 3 per category per day, so the collection stays coherent.
- Hero rows are searched first, then Core, then Add-on. Within a subcategory keep at most 3 live products unless they differ in style.
- Add-ons are for cross-sell and bundles. Tag them custom_label_2 = addon so they can be excluded from Shopping campaigns or bid low.

5. Taxonomy: categories, subcategories and search inputs (103 rows)

This is the bot's search list and the Excel grouping. Band = marketable US price range (band_max comes from the verified sourcing catalogue and competitor prices). Landed cap = most the landed cost can be when priced at band_max. Role: Hero (hero gates, ad priority), Core, Add-on (cross-sell), Hold (disabled). Ship risk: likelihood of failing the \$5 shipping cap (heavy items). Google categories must be validated against Google's official product taxonomy file; if a path does not match exactly, use the nearest parent and log it.

Category	Subcategory	AliExpress keywords	Role	Band US\$	Landed cap	Ship risk	Google product category
Coats	Belted camel wrap coat	women camel belted wrap coat long	Hero	178–248	\$48	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Coats	Double-breasted long coat	women double breasted long coat	Core	178–248	\$48	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Coats	Long faux fur coat	women faux fur long coat	Core	198–268	\$52	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Coats	Cape coat	women cape coat	Core	158–218	\$42	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Coats	Faux-fur-collar coat	women coat faux fur collar	Core	178–248	\$48	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Coats	Funnel-neck coat	women funnel neck coat	Core	178–238	\$46	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Coats	Toggle duffle coat	women toggle duffle coat hooded	Core	158–218	\$42	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Coats	Long matte down coat	women long matte down coat hooded	Core	188–258	\$50	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Coats	Cocoon coat	women cocoon coat	Core	168–228	\$44	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Coats	Lined trench coat	women long trench coat lined	Core	148–198	\$38	High	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Jackets & Gilets	Barn jacket, corduroy collar	women barn jacket corduroy collar	Hero	118–168	\$32	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Jackets & Gilets	Diamond-quilted jacket	women diamond quilted jacket corduroy collar	Core	108–148	\$28	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Jackets & Gilets	Quilted gilet	women quilted gilet vest	Core	68–98	\$19	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Vests
Jackets & Gilets	Faux leather bomber	women faux leather bomber jacket	Core	108–148	\$28	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Jackets & Gilets	Faux shearling jacket	women faux shearling aviator jacket	Core	128–178	\$34	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Jackets & Gilets	Faux suede jacket	women faux suede jacket	Core	118–158	\$30	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Sweaters	Chunky cable crewneck	women cable knit sweater crew neck	Hero	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Sweaters	Fine-rib turtleneck	women ribbed turtleneck sweater slim	Hero	48–68	\$13	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Sweaters	Cashmere-blend crewneck	women cashmere blend crew neck sweater	Core	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Sweaters	Fair Isle yoke sweater	women fair isle sweater	Core	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Sweaters	Half-zip knit	women half zip knit sweater	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Sweaters	Striped boat-neck knit	women striped boat neck sweater	Core	58–78	\$15	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Sweaters	Funnel-neck sweater	women funnel neck sweater	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Sweaters	Cricket V-neck	women cricket sweater v neck	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Sweaters	Sweater vest	women knit sweater vest v neck	Core	48–68	\$13	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Sweaters	Asymmetric one-shoulder knit	women asymmetric one shoulder knit sweater	Core	58–78	\$15	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Cardigans	Cable cardigan, gold buttons	women cable knit cardigan gold buttons	Hero	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Cardigans	Fine-knit crew cardigan	women crew neck fine knit cardigan	Core	58–78	\$15	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Cardigans	Pearl-button V-neck cardigan	women v neck cardigan pearl buttons	Core	58–78	\$15	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Cardigans	Long belted wrap cardigan	women long belted wrap cardigan	Core	78–108	\$20	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Cardigans	Shawl-collar chunky cardigan	women shawl collar chunky cardigan	Core	78–108	\$20	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Knit Sets	Sweater + wide-leg trouser set	women knit two piece set wide leg pants	Core	108–148	\$28	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outfit Sets
Knit Sets	Sweater + midi skirt set	women knit sweater midi skirt set	Core	108–148	\$28	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outfit Sets
Knit Sets	Ribbed cardigan + trouser set	women ribbed knit lounge set cardigan	Core	88–128	\$24	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outfit Sets
Blazers & Tailoring	Double-breasted blazer, gold buttons	women double breasted blazer gold buttons	Hero	108–148	\$28	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Blazers & Tailoring	Houndstooth or tweed blazer	women houndstooth blazer	Core	108–148	\$28	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets

Category	Subcategory	AliExpress keywords	Role	Band US\$	Landed cap	Ship risk	Google product category
Blazers & Tailoring	Velvet blazer	women velvet blazer	Core	118–158	\$30	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Blazers & Tailoring	Trouser suit	women suit set blazer trousers	Core	158–218	\$42	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Suits > Pant Suits
Blazers & Tailoring	Tuxedo blazer, satin lapel	women tuxedo blazer satin lapel	Core	118–158	\$30	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Coats & Jackets
Blazers & Tailoring	Skirt suit	women blazer skirt suit set	Core	148–198	\$38	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Suits > Skirt Suits
Blazers & Tailoring	Tailored waistcoat	women tailored waistcoat	Core	58–78	\$15	Medium	A&A > Clothing > Outerwear > Vests
Tops & Shirts	Oxford shirt	women classic oxford shirt	Core	48–68	\$13	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Tops & Shirts	Satin shirt	women satin button shirt	Core	58–78	\$15	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Tops & Shirts	Bow-neck blouse	women bow tie neck blouse	Core	58–78	\$15	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Tops & Shirts	Fitted turtleneck top	women slim turtleneck long sleeve top	Core	28–48	\$9	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Tops & Shirts	Striped poplin shirt	women striped poplin shirt	Core	48–68	\$13	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Tops & Shirts	Ruffle high-neck blouse	women ruffle high neck victorian blouse	Core	58–78	\$15	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Tops & Shirts	Long-sleeve knit polo	women long sleeve knit polo	Core	48–68	\$13	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Tops & Shirts	Square-neck bodysuit	women long sleeve square neck bodysuit	Core	28–48	\$9	Low	A&A > Clothing > Shirts & Tops
Trousers	Pleated wide-leg trousers	women high waist wide leg pleated trousers	Hero	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Pants
Trousers	Straight flannel trousers	women grey flannel straight trousers	Core	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Pants
Trousers	Corduroy wide-leg trousers	women corduroy wide leg pants high waist	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Pants
Trousers	Velvet wide-leg trousers	women velvet wide leg trousers	Core	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Pants
Trousers	Dark straight jeans	women high waist straight jeans dark wash	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Pants
Trousers	Riding-style trousers	women equestrian riding pants	Core	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Pants
Trousers	Houndstooth trousers	women houndstooth trousers	Core	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Pants
Trousers	Knit wide-leg trousers	women knit wide leg pants	Core	58–78	\$15	Low	A&A > Clothing > Pants
Skirts	Pleated midi skirt	women pleated midi skirt	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Skirts
Skirts	Tartan midi skirt	women plaid midi skirt	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Skirts
Skirts	A-line midi skirt	women a line midi skirt winter	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Skirts
Skirts	Satin slip midi	women satin midi slip skirt	Core	48–68	\$13	Low	A&A > Clothing > Skirts
Skirts	Faux suede midi	women faux suede midi skirt	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Skirts
Skirts	Velvet midi	women velvet midi skirt	Core	58–88	\$17	Low	A&A > Clothing > Skirts
Skirts	Ribbed knit midi	women ribbed knit midi skirt	Core	48–68	\$13	Low	A&A > Clothing > Skirts
Dresses	Ribbed knit midi dress	women ribbed knit midi dress long sleeve	Hero	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Dresses
Dresses	Long-sleeve velvet midi	women velvet midi dress long sleeve	Hero	88–128	\$24	Low	A&A > Clothing > Dresses
Dresses	Turtleneck sweater dress	women turtleneck sweater dress midi	Core	78–108	\$20	Low	A&A > Clothing > Dresses
Dresses	Long-sleeve wrap dress	women long sleeve wrap midi dress	Core	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Dresses
Dresses	Satin slip dress	women satin slip midi dress	Core	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Dresses
Dresses	Off-shoulder velvet dress	women off shoulder velvet midi dress	Core	88–128	\$24	Low	A&A > Clothing > Dresses
Dresses	Belted shirt dress	women belted shirt dress midi	Core	68–98	\$19	Low	A&A > Clothing > Dresses
Dresses	Pinafore dress	women pinafore dress winter	Core	78–108	\$20	Low	A&A > Clothing > Dresses
Scarves & Gloves	Oversized scarf	women oversized scarf solid winter	Add-on	38–58	\$11	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Scarves & Shawls
Scarves & Gloves	Soft-handle solid scarf	women solid soft scarf	Add-on	28–48	\$9	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Scarves & Shawls
Scarves & Gloves	Lined leather gloves	women leather gloves lined	Add-on	38–58	\$11	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Gloves & Mittens
Scarves & Gloves	Tartan blanket scarf	women plaid blanket scarf	Add-on	28–48	\$9	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Scarves & Shawls
Scarves & Gloves	Equestrian-print square scarf	women square scarf equestrian print	Add-on	28–38	\$7	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Scarves & Shawls
Hats & Hair	Beret	women wool beret	Add-on	28–38	\$7	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Hats
Hats & Hair	Faux fur hat	women faux fur hat	Add-on	38–58	\$11	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Hats

Category	Subcategory	AliExpress keywords	Role	Band US\$	Landed cap	Ship risk	Google product category
Hats & Hair	Cable-knit beanie	women cable knit beanie	Add-on	28–38	\$7	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Hats
Hats & Hair	Faux fur earmuffs	women faux fur earmuffs	Add-on	28–38	\$7	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Earmuffs
Hats & Hair	Padded velvet headband	women padded velvet headband	Add-on	18–28	\$5	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Hair Accessories
Hats & Hair	Velvet hair bow	women velvet hair bow clip	Add-on	25–25	\$4	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Hair Accessories
Hats & Hair	Pearl hair clip	women pearl hair clip	Add-on	25–25	\$4	Low	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Hair Accessories
Bags & Belts	Structured top-handle bag	women structured top handle bag	Core	88–128	\$24	Medium	A&A > Handbags, Wallets & Cases > Handbags
Bags & Belts	Suede shoulder bag	women suede shoulder bag	Core	88–118	\$22	Medium	A&A > Handbags, Wallets & Cases > Handbags
Bags & Belts	Saddle crossbody	women saddle crossbody bag	Core	68–98	\$19	Medium	A&A > Handbags, Wallets & Cases > Handbags
Bags & Belts	Velvet evening clutch	women velvet clutch bag	Add-on	48–68	\$13	Medium	A&A > Handbags, Wallets & Cases > Handbags
Bags & Belts	Leather belt, gold buckle	women leather belt gold buckle	Add-on	28–48	\$9	Medium	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Belts
Bags & Belts	Wide waist belt	women wide waist belt	Add-on	28–48	\$9	Medium	A&A > Clothing Accessories > Belts
Jewelry	Pearl stud earrings	women pearl stud earrings	Add-on	18–28	\$5	Low	A&A > Jewelry > Earrings
Jewelry	Chunky gold hoops	women chunky gold hoop earrings	Add-on	28–38	\$7	Low	A&A > Jewelry > Earrings
Jewelry	Pearl drop earrings	women pearl drop earrings gold	Add-on	28–38	\$7	Low	A&A > Jewelry > Earrings
Jewelry	Single-strand pearl necklace	women pearl necklace single strand	Add-on	28–48	\$9	Low	A&A > Jewelry > Necklaces
Jewelry	Herringbone chain	women herringbone chain necklace gold	Add-on	28–48	\$9	Low	A&A > Jewelry > Necklaces
Jewelry	Signet ring	women gold signet ring	Add-on	28–38	\$7	Low	A&A > Jewelry > Rings
Boots & Shoes	Flat knee-high riding boots	women knee high riding boots flat	Hold	148–198	\$38	High	A&A > Shoes
Boots & Shoes	Tall slim heeled boots	women knee high slim heel boots	Hold	148–198	\$38	High	A&A > Shoes
Boots & Shoes	Lined Chelsea boots	women chelsea boots warm lined	Hold	108–148	\$28	High	A&A > Shoes
Boots & Shoes	Lined suede ankle boots	women suede ankle boots fleece lined	Hold	108–148	\$28	High	A&A > Shoes
Boots & Shoes	Waterproof lace-up boots	women waterproof lace up winter boots	Hold	118–158	\$30	High	A&A > Shoes
Boots & Shoes	Penny loafers	women penny loafers	Hold	88–118	\$22	High	A&A > Shoes
Boots & Shoes	Velvet flats	women velvet ballet flats	Hold	58–78	\$15	High	A&A > Shoes

A&A = Apparel & Accessories. Renamed rows versus the old catalogue: Cashmere-feel scarf is now Soft-handle solid scarf; wool-named skirts, pinafore, scarf and beret drop “wool” from the name until composition confirms it (C-01).

6. Data sources and pipeline

6.1 AliExpress Open Platform APIs

Purpose	Method (verify against current Open Platform docs)	Key inputs and outputs
Discovery	aliexpress.affiliate.product.query	keywords, category_ids, ship_to_country, sort by sales volume, target_currency USD, target_language EN, page_no, page_size, and a delivery_days pre-filter where supported. Returns product IDs, sale price, volume, positive rate, images
Product detail	aliexpress.ds.product.get	product_id, ship_to_country (run for US, GB, CA). Returns SKUs with price and stock, properties (brand, material), images, store ratings, package size and weight
Freight	aliexpress.ds.freight.query or aliexpress.logistics.buyer.freight.calculate (use whichever is currently documented)	product_id, sku_id, country, postcode, quantity 1. Returns each method's cost, delivery estimate and tracking
Backup suppliers	aliexpress.ds.image.search	main image. Returns visually similar products to test as backups

Setup: register an app on the AliExpress Open Platform, request Affiliate and Dropshipping API permissions, and authorise with the same AliExpress account linked to DSers, so quoted prices match what DSers pays. Map field names from real responses and write the mapping to a file; never guess. Any gate field not returned (photo reviews, store age and positive feedback may be missing) is UNVERIFIED.

6.2 Stage details

- **S1 Discover.** For each enabled taxonomy row, run its keywords with ship_to_country US, sorted by sales volume, up to 3 pages of 50. Skip product IDs checked in the last 7 days unless they are live.
- **S2 Pre-filter.** Drop products whose sale price exceeds the item-price ceiling ($((\text{band_max} \times k - 0.30 - 4.99) \div (1 + \text{US duty rate}))$), or whose orders or rating are below the tier minimum.
- **S3 Enrich.** Call product detail for US, GB and CA. Choose the listable SKUs (on-palette colours, core sizes, within the 15% price spread). Run freight for the heaviest listable SKU in each country.
- **S4 Gate.** Apply G-01 to G-20 and F-01 to F-12 in order; stop at the first REJECT but record every flag.
- **S5 Vision.** Run the rubric (3.5) and white-label test (3.1) only on products that reached this stage, to control cost.
- **S6 Cluster.** Treat two products as the same when the perceptual hash of the main image differs by 8 bits or less and titles are 80% similar. Primary = highest score, then lowest landed cost. Next two passing products become backups.
- **S7 Price.** Section 1. Write custom labels: 0 = category, 1 = headroom tier (A 20%+, B 10% to 20%, C under 10%), 2 = role, 3 = edit tag, 4 = price band.
- **S8 Copy.** Generate the Vourelle title, description, SEO fields, alt text and tags (section 9.4), then run the linter (3.2).
- **S9 Output.** Write the Excel workbook (section 7) and import_queue.json with the approved product IDs, chosen SKUs, prices, copy and backup IDs.

6.3 Running 24/7 reliably

- Scheduler: discovery every 6 hours, monitoring every 12 hours, Excel written after each run. Use a job queue so a failed product does not stop the run.
- Rate limits: respect the documented call limits; exponential backoff with jitter, maximum 5 retries, then mark the product ERROR and move on.
- State store (SQLite to start, Postgres at scale): products, daily snapshots (price, stock, freight, status), decisions with reason codes, runs, and the DSers and Shopify IDs for each product.
- Cache product detail for 12 hours; never cache freight used for a final decision.
- Dry-run mode, structured logs, and an alert (email or Slack) when a run fails, an API error rate exceeds 5%, or a live product is paused.
- Health report in the workbook: API calls used, products scanned, pass rate per gate and per country, runtime.

7. Excel output specification

File: output/vourelle_candidates_YYYY-MM-DD.xlsx each run day, plus output/vourelle_master.xlsx updated in place (one row per product ID, latest status). Build with openpyxl. Rows sorted by Category, then Subcategory, then score (highest first).

Sheet	Contents
README	Run time, config version, counts by status, links to the other sheets
Summary	Pivot of Category × Subcategory × Status counts, average score, average margin and headroom
Pass_Rates	Funnel per gate and per country (US, GB, CA) for this run; highlights the gate that rejects the most
Approved	All APPROVED and APPROVED_QUEUED rows, every category
One tab per category	Coats, Jackets & Gilets, Sweaters ... Jewelry: that category's Approved and Review rows, grouped by Subcategory
Review	REVIEW rows with the human_check column filled in and a blank decision column (approve or reject) that the bot reads back
Rejected	Last 30 days of rejections with reason codes
Live_Monitor	Every LIVE and PAUSED product with the latest check and any action taken
Config_Snapshot	The config values used for the run
Reason_Codes	Dictionary of every G-, F- and status code with its meaning

#	Column	Content and format
1-6	run_date, status, category, subcategory, role, score	Date; status text with colour fill; taxonomy values; integer 0 to 100
7-12	product_id, cluster_id, product_url, store_name, store_id, supplier_title	Product URL as a clickable hyperlink
13-14	vourelle_title, main_image_url	Generated SEO title; image link (thumbnail optional)
15-21	orders, rating, reviews, photo_reviews, store_dsr_min, store_positive_feedback, store_age_years	Numbers; the text UNVERIFIED where not available
22-27	colours_total, palette_colours, sizes, sku_count_listed, stock_total, min_core_size_stock	Lists as comma-separated text
28-36	us_method, us_ship_usd, us_days_max, gb_method, gb_ship_usd, gb_days_max, ca_method, ca_ship_usd, ca_days_max	Currency to 2 decimals; days as integers; cell turns red if a cap is breached
37	ships_from	Country code
38-42	item_price_usd, landed_us, landed_gb, landed_ca, landed_max	USD, 2 decimals
43-49	min_price_usd, band, price_usd, price_gbp, price_cad, markup, net_margin_at_target_roas	Prices; markup as 0.00x; margin as %
50-51	breakeven_roas, headroom_pct	Number to 2 decimals; %
52-55	premium_look_score, whitelabel, composition, claims_allowed	1 to 5; PASS, UNVERIFIED or FAIL; text; for example wool:no leather:no
56-57	google_product_category, custom_labels	Validated taxonomy path; labels 0 to 4
58-60	flags, reject_reasons, human_check	Codes separated by commas; plain-English instruction for the reviewer
61-64	decision, backup_1_id, backup_2_id, last_checked	Reviewer input (approve or reject); backup IDs; timestamp

Formatting: navy bold header on ivory, frozen header row and first four columns, filters on, sensible widths, currency and percentage formats, status fills (green APPROVED, amber REVIEW, red REJECTED, blue LIVE). The Review sheet's decision column is the only cell a human edits; the next run reads it and moves the row.

8. DSers and Shopify

8.1 Getting approved products into DSers

- **Option A, most automated:** an open-source DSers MCP server exists that can import supplier URLs, apply edits and push to Shopify. It is third-party, not a DSers product, and it needs your DSers session. Self-host it only after reviewing the code, keep the session token in a secrets store, and pin the version.
- **Option B, safest:** the bot writes the approved product URLs to `import_queue.json` and the Approved sheet; you paste them into the DSers Import List once a day (about a minute for 10 products). Everything else stays automated.
- DSers will not import the same product twice unless it is deleted, so the bot must check its state store before queueing.

8.2 DSers settings

- Push products to Shopify as **drafts**. The bot publishes only after enrichment (8.3) succeeds.
- Turn automatic stock sync **on**. Turn DSers price overwriting **off**, or set a pricing rule that cannot undercut the bot's price; the bot owns prices.
- Set the shipping method per country to the exact method that passed the gates.
- Map the two backup suppliers (Basic Mapping, backup supplier) so an out-of-stock primary is swapped automatically where the plan allows.
- Add the order note from 3.1 to every order.

8.3 Shopify enrichment (Admin GraphQL API)

- Replace the title, description, SEO title, SEO description and URL handle with the generated copy.
- Delete off-palette and out-of-band variants; rename options to Color and Size; add the size chart (cm with US and UK sizes) as a metafield.
- Set product type = category, and tags: new, cat:<category>, sub:<subcategory>, role:<role>, and edit:<edit>.
- Set the USD price and leave compare-at empty. Set GBP and CAD prices through Shopify Markets; if fixed per-market prices are not available on the plan, use Markets rounding rules and check that the result still clears P_min.
- Upload the processed images (9.3) with alt text, and write the Google fields (category, gender female, age group adult, condition new, custom labels) to the metafields read by the Google & YouTube app.
- Publish, confirm the product appears in the feed, then set status LIVE.

9. Google Merchant Center compliance

Dropshipping is allowed on Google, but misrepresentation is the most common reason dropshipping stores are suspended, and Google treats it as serious. The rules below are what keep the account approved.

9.1 Store checklist (human set-up; the bot re-checks weekly)

- Contact page with business name, email, phone and address that match Merchant Center, Google Ads and payments profiles exactly. Complete identity verification when asked.
- Shipping policy per country: processing time plus an honest delivery window with a buffer above the 9-day filter, costs, and who pays duties. Say duties are included for the US only if AliExpress collects them at checkout; state that UK prices include VAT.
- Returns and refunds policy: window, condition, who pays return postage, and a real return address or process. Decide this before launch; returning items to China is often impractical, so a local returns address or refund-without-return for low-value items are common choices.
- Privacy policy, terms of service, secure checkout, no password page, no placeholder text, no broken links.
- Honest About page (founded 2026). No fake reviews, countdown timers, fake stock counts or “was” prices.

9.2 Feed attributes

Attribute	Value
id / item_group_id	Variant SKU / Shopify product ID, so every size and colour is a variant of one group
title	Vourelle + product type + key detail + material (only if C-rules allow) + color + Women's, 150 characters or fewer, most important words first, no promotional text
brand	Vourelle (you sell it as your own label). Confirm this with Merchant Center guidance for unbranded goods sold under a store label
gtin / identifier_exists / mpn	No GTIN: identifier_exists = no; mpn = internal SKU
google_product_category, product_type	Validated taxonomy path; product_type = Women > Category > Subcategory
gender, age_group, color, size, size_system	female, adult, mapped palette colour, size label; size_system US for the US and Canada, UK for the UK
material	From composition, following C-rules
price, availability, shipping	Must always match the website; availability follows DSers stock sync
custom_label_0 to 4	Category, headroom tier, role, edit, price band (section 6.2, S7)
image_link, additional_image_link, lifestyle_image_link	See 9.3

9.3 Images and AI enhancement

- Main image: the piece clearly shown, flat or on a model, on a plain light background, filling roughly 75% to 90% of the frame. No text, badges, watermarks, borders or logos.
- Styled or scene backgrounds go in lifestyle_image_link or additional images, not the main image.
- AI may clean backgrounds, correct colour, upscale and restyle scenes, but must never change the garment's shape, colour, fabric texture, trims or fit. The image must match what arrives.
- Google requires AI-generated images to keep their IPTC DigitalSourceType metadata (TrainedAlgorithmicMedia; CompositeSynthetic for composites). The image pipeline must write and preserve this tag.
- Export at 1,200 × 1,200 pixels or larger. Google has announced stricter enforcement of small images from January 31, 2027.

9.4 SEO copy

- Shopify SEO title 60 characters or fewer, meta description 155 or fewer, handle in lower-case words with hyphens.
- Description: one line of feeling, then fit, composition, care, sizing guidance and delivery window. Primary keyword (from the taxonomy row) in the title, first sentence and first image alt text.

- Alt text per image: Vourelle + piece + color + view (front, back, detail, on model).

9.5 Campaign guardrails (human-owned)

- One Shopping or feed-only Performance Max campaign per market. Start with maximise conversion value; move to a 200% target ROAS once conversion volume is stable.
- Headroom tier C products get a stricter target (220%). Add-ons are excluded or bid lowest.
- Review search terms and product performance weekly (H-5). The bot never edits campaigns.

10. Monitoring live products

Trigger (checked every 12 hours)	Action
Core-size stock under 20 in a colour	Set that variant to out of stock; if the colour drops below G-10, hide the colour
Total stock under 200, or listing offline	Switch to backup 1, then backup 2 (re-gate first); if none pass, set PAUSED and remove from the feed
Supplier price change of 5% or more	Recalculate P_min; raise price within band if needed; if above band_max, switch supplier or pause
Delivery estimate 10+ days or shipping \$5+ in any country	Try backups; otherwise pause the product in that market (exclude the country in the feed) and alert
New red flag (F-01 to F-12)	Move to REVIEW; keep live unless the flag is F-06 or offline
Merchant Center item disapproval	Unpublish that item from the feed, record the reason, alert
Any change to a live product	Log the before and after values in Live_Monitor

11. Acceptance tests Claude Code must pass

ID	Input	Expected
T-01	Landed \$16.58, band \$68 to \$98	P_min \$85.66, price \$88, margin about 10.6%
T-02	Landed \$19.00, band max \$98 / landed \$19.10	Pass at \$98 / REJECT PRICE_OVER_BAND (\$108)
T-03	US shipping \$5.00	REJECT SHIP_COST_US (\$4.99 passes)
T-04	Canada max delivery 10 days / 9 days	REJECT SHIP_SLOW_CA / pass
T-05	Item \$2.90, UK shipping \$3.20	REJECT SHIP_GT_ITEM
T-06	No freight method to Canada	REJECT SHIP_MISSING_CA
T-07	Every SKU stock 99999	Flag F-01, status REVIEW
T-08	Title “Burberry style check scarf” / “hunter green cable knit”	REJECT DESIGN_COPY / pass
T-09	Composition 20% wool	Title and tags contain no “wool”; composition listed in description
T-10	25 products qualify in one day	10 APPROVED (max 3 per category), the rest APPROVED_QUEUED
T-11	Run the same stage twice	No duplicate rows, imports or API side effects
T-12	Copy containing “!”, emoji or “luxury”	Linter fails; copy regenerated
T-13	Any API call for the UK	Uses country code GB
T-14	Open the workbook	All sheets present, filters on, headers frozen, links clickable, sorted by category and subcategory

Appendix A. Configuration (vourelle_bot_config.yaml)

The same content is supplied as a separate file. Claude Code should load that file rather than copying from this page.

```
# VOURELLE sourcing bot - configuration (v2026-09-30)
# Master spec: Vourelle_Sourcing_Bot_Spec.pdf. Every threshold below is a config value, never a hard-coded constant.
version: "2026-09-30"
```

```
economics:
  target_roas: 2.0          # pricing formula in spec section 2
  refund_rate: 0.12         # Google Ads, conversion value = revenue excl. tax and shipping
  payment_fee_rate: 0.035   # share of gross sales refunded; replace with actuals monthly
  payment_fee_fixed_usd: 0.30
  overhead_rate: 0.06
  target_net_margin: 0.10   # of net sales (gross minus refunds)
  price_ending_digit: 8     # 48, 58, 68 ... 248

markets:
  US: {iso: US, currency: USD, fx_per_usd: 1.00, sample_postcode: "10001",
       duty_rate: {garment: 0.45, footwear: 0.50, bag_belt_hat: 0.40, jewelry: 0.35}}
  UK: {iso: GB, currency: GBP, fx_per_usd: 0.74, sample_postcode: "SW1A 1AA",
       vat_rate: 0.20, prices_include_vat: true, duty_rate: 0.00, duty_relief_review_date: "2028-10-01"}
  CA: {iso: CA, currency: CAD, fx_per_usd: 1.40, sample_postcode: "M5V 2T6",
       duty_rate: {garment: 0.18, other: 0.10}, duty_verified: false} # confirm on a real checkout before launch

shipping:
  required_countries: [US, GB, CA] # must pass all three
  max_delivery_days: 9              # "less than 10 days": processing + transit, upper bound of estimate
  max_ship_cost_usd: 4.99          # cheapest qualifying tracked method, per unit, each country
  require_tracking: true
  reject_if_ship_cost_gt_item_price: true
  check_sku: heaviest              # run freight for the heaviest/largest SKU you will list

supplier_gates:
  standard: {min_orders: 500, min_reviews: 100, min_rating: 4.6, min_photo_reviews: 10}
  hero:     {min_orders: 1000, min_reviews: 300, min_rating: 4.7, min_photo_reviews: 25}
  addon:    {min_orders: 300, min_reviews: 50, min_rating: 4.6, min_photo_reviews: 5}
  store_min_dsr: 4.6              # item-as-described, communication, shipping-speed ratings
  store_min_positive_feedback: 0.95
  store_min_age_years: 1

variants:
  apparel: {min_colours: 3, min_palette_colours: 2, required_sizes: [S, M, L, XL],
           preferred_sizes: [XS, XXL], min_skus: 12, max_variant_price_spread: 0.15}
  one_size: {min_colours: 2, min_palette_colours: 1}

inventory:
  apparel: {min_total_stock: 1000, min_stock_per_core_size: 100} # core sizes S, M, L in each listed colour
  one_size: {min_total_stock: 500}
  placeholder_stock_values: [999, 9999, 99999, 999999]

quality:
  min_images: 5
  min_premium_look_score: 4      # 1-5, vision model rubric in spec section 3.5
  vision_images_checked: 6

palette: [camel, oatmeal, cream, ivory, white, stone, beige, tan, cognac, chestnut, brown, chocolate,
          navy, charcoal, grey, black, burgundy, wine, bottle green, hunter green, emerald, olive,
          champagne, pale blue, blue white stripe, gold, pearl]

blocklist_terms: [burberry, nova check, hermes, kelly, birkin, constance, chanel, coco, gucci, horsebit,
                  louis vuitton, monogram, dior, prada, miu miu, celine, loewe, bottega, intrecciato,
                  loro piana, max mara, ralph lauren, barbour, moncler, canada goose, ugg, toteme,
                  the row, reformation, sezane, zara, mango, aritzia, skims, real fur, mink, fox fur,
                  rabbit fur, raccoon fur]
blocklist_whitelist_phrases: [hunter green, knit polo, polo collar, polo neck]

scoring:
  weights: {margin_headroom: 20, social_proof: 20, sales_velocity: 15, premium_look: 20,
            delivery_speed: 10, variants_palette: 10, shipping_cost: 5}
  approve_min_score: 70
  review_min_score: 55

throughput:
  discovery_interval_hours: 6
  monitor_interval_hours: 12
  max_new_approved_per_day: 10
  max_per_category_per_day: 3
  backups_per_product: 2

monitoring:
```

```
core_size_stock_floor: 20  
total_stock_floor: 200  
supplier_price_change_trigger: 0.05
```

```
output:  
excel_dir: ./output  
daily_file: vourelle_candidates_{date}.xlsx  
master_file: vourelle_master.xlsx  
keep_rejected_days: 30
```

Appendix B. Sources and limits

Checked September 2026: Google Merchant Center Help (misrepresentation, AI-generated content and image link pages); third-party 2026 guides on dropshipping suspensions and image rules; AliExpress Open Platform method names via published SDKs and documentation mirrors (affiliate product query with `ship_to_country` and `delivery_days`; `ds.product.get`; `freight calculate`; `image search`); DSers help centre (import list, backup supplier mapping); 2026 AliExpress Choice delivery tracking reports; US apparel duty guides (36% to 52% total as of September 2026); UK low-value import relief ending October 2028 (GOV.UK, Deloitte); ROAS benchmarks for fashion (Google median 3.52, Meta 2.18).

Not verified and must be confirmed during the build: exact API response field names and which store and review fields are returned; current API call limits; Canadian duty and tax handling on AliExpress orders; whether your Shopify plan supports fixed per-market prices; whether Merchant Center accepts Vourelle as the brand for unbranded supplier goods; the DSers MCP server's code and security. Tariff rules changed several times in 2025 and 2026, so duty rates in config need a monthly check.

This document is operating guidance, not legal or tax advice. Confirm VAT, duty and consumer-law obligations with a qualified adviser before launch in each market.